The Turning

Read this before the first session. It says what the world is, and how to make a character who lives here. The cards in the world book are the full rules, and this primer is the first reading.

What this world is

Vampires, werewolves, and their kin live in the Turning, and the people around them know what they are. Towns accept them, employ them, and need them, so each one is a neighbour with a job and a cost.

You are born a Kind, which is the body you arrive in, and most people also become a Condition, a change that comes later. Both sit on the same person.

Towns have charters, guild halls, markets, letters of credit, mills, and universities, and they have no printing press and no gunpowder. Past the mills and the letters of credit, the new work is what a Condition can do: a voice that carries a feeling past a storm, a Gaze that holds a wound still, a second body that does the heavy labor. A Tithe is the upkeep that makes that work possible, the cost you meet so you can live well with what you became.

The present year is Cut-year 387, counted from the First Cut, and this age is the Years of Hands, when a town's own Turning Tree is the ordinary way a child Turns.

Kind and Condition

Kind is the body you are born in. Human, Elf, Kitsune, Selkie, Tengu, Yumboe, and the other Daggerheart ancestries are Kinds, and a Kind is ordinary. Nobody stares at a fox-tail in a market, or at wings on a ridge. A Kind does not keep a country of its own. The place you live in raises you.

Condition is what you become. About three people in four acquire one over a lifetime, and about one in four never do. Law, guilds, medicine, and ordinary jobs are built around what a Condition can do, and around helping the person meet its cost.

A Condition arrives in one of two ways.

At the Leaf-Fall, the ceremony under the town's Turning Tree in a child's tenth year, a coloured leaf falls on the child and a Condition is Given. If the leaves hug the child and no colour falls, that child is one of the Kept. The Tree left them as they are, the town watched the hug, and the Kept are wanted in their own right.

Some people are Struck later, with no leaf and no ceremony. They died and came back, they swore a contract, they survived a drowning, they survived being turned to stone, or they were lost and dying in the deep wild and the wild took them in. A ten-year-old cannot die and walk back, and a child cannot swear a contract, because the Tree does not Give a contract. Some of the Kept are Struck later, once a threshold finds them.

Counted across a whole life, about sixty people in a hundred are Given, about fifteen are Struck, and about twenty-five stay Kept. At the ceremony itself, about forty children in a hundred are hugged, and a little over a third of those hugged children are Struck someday. Kept names the present. It does not promise that no threshold will come.

A child who never stood under a Tree is UnTurned. A missed week, a refusal, and a week under a Tree that could not Turn all end the same way. Neighbours sometimes say Kept, because from the street the two lives can look alike, and the law says UnTurned. A Kept person was hugged while the town watched.

Every Condition carries a Tithe, and you meet that upkeep in order to live well with what you became. Meet it, and you are a valued citizen. Fall behind, and the cost shows in the body: a Long-Lived, who stops aging and keeps every memory, starts to forget, a Two-Bodied person shifts into the other body at a bad moment, and a Far-Voiced person lets a feeling break out of the voice as a Cry. One of the Stilled locks a limb when the stillness they have been carrying settles, and an Answered person, whom one element answers, lets that element go in a crowded room. You still choose what you do. A Tithe does not take a person over, and no Condition can compel another person.

You carry one Condition. The card does not grow when you level, so the card at level 1 is the card at level 10. It sits among your cards the way a heritage card does, the card for the ancestry you were born, and it does not count against your domain cards, the abilities your class collects as you advance.

The Leaf-Fall

A Turning Tree stands in the square, on the green, or in a temple-yard. For most of the year it looks like a great oak or beech, and it is its own kind of tree. Children climb the low boughs, a court can meet in the shade, and cutting a mark into the bark is taboo.

There is one origin Tree, the Awakening Tree. The old spelling is Thaeloren, said THAEL-or-en, and everyday speech wears that long name down to the Thallow. It stands on Maiethorn, in the old country people call the Sacred Core. Every town Tree is a living graft of that wood. Wardens cut a piece, carry it in living earth, and plant it, and the piece on the road is called a scion. A newly planted Tree cannot hold a Leaf-Fall. People reckon that wait as about a generation, and until then the children go to a neighbour’s Tree.

The Leaf-Fall is held in Turning-Week, the week that holds the High Solstice, in midsummer. Every child who has turned ten since the last solstice stands under the canopy. The town’s tree-warden says what the leaves did, the town watches, and the week is a rite and also the town’s great fair.

The colour of the leaf names the Condition.

Leaf	Condition
Deep red	Long-Lived
Storm-grey	Two-Bodied
Lamp-amber	The Answered. The shade names the element: Ember (fire), Tide (water), Root (earth and stone), or Gale (air)
Sea-blue	Far-Voiced
Pale stone	The Stilled
Copper-green	The Taken-In. This green is metallic, and it is not the Tree’s summer green
White-fire	Phoenix. Almost no living town has seen this leaf. A town-warden sends word of it to the First Seat, the wardens at the Awakening Tree, rather than announcing Phoenix in the square

A hug is the Tree’s own summer green, and it has no naming colour. Returned, Bound, and the Unbound have no leaf-colour. The Tree Gives, or it Keeps, and a Strike happens later, away from the Tree.

A child has one week for a Gift, in the tenth year. A completed standing happens once. That standing is a colour, or a hug, under wood the warden called sound, and the warden’s announcement of it is the Speaking. If the Speaking misnames the colour or the hug, the word can be corrected, and the standing itself is not run again.

A sick Tree is skipped, and the children use a neighbour’s Tree in that same week. If they stand under wood the warden knows cannot Turn, the week is spent, and those children are UnTurned. Next summer they may visit the square. The visit is not a second Gift.

A city keeps one Tree and the same one week. A hearth stands for the child, a quay, a courtyard, or a guild-stair, people who already know them, and that hearth takes a morning, an afternoon, or an evening. The warden says the colour or the hug out loud. Threnmaieth, said THREN-mai-eth, writes the stand down, and other towns leave it spoken. A village still watches as one circle.

Some people hold that the Leaf-Mother blessed the world with these gifts, and that the Trees are her hands. Neighbours call that faith the Motherfaith, and its own name is Maieth. Skeptics say the Trees do what a plant does. Both kinds of people stand in the same week, because you belong by what you do. You bring the children, you tend the Tithe, and you keep the festival. People argue whether a hug is a gift of being left whole or a child passed over, and they argue whether a Strike is still her doing or came some other way. Nobody in the square has closed those questions.

The ten Conditions

Nine of these can be chosen at character creation, when the path allows. The Unbound comes only when a Bound term ends, and you do not pick it off a list. Each share below is a share of all people. The Unbound's share sits inside Bound's share, and it is not added on top.

Far-Voiced, the Stilled, and the Taken-In can be Given or Struck, and most of them are Given. For each of those three, the people who were Struck are about one person in a hundred. Long-Lived, Two-Bodied, the Answered, and Phoenix are Given only. Returned and Bound are Struck only.

The paragraph that begins with **Tithe** is the upkeep. Most Tithes are checked once at a long rest, and two short rests in one day leave the tokens as they are. Far-Voiced, Two-Bodied, Bound, and Phoenix use a different time, and that paragraph says so. The card in the world book lists any step between a first miss and the end named here.

Long-Lived. Old tales called them vampires, and what the towns actually have is a keeper of memory. The Tree Gives this Condition, and only the Tree, by the deep-red leaf, and about 2.5 percent of people live this way. Aging stops, they forget nothing they have witnessed, and one drop of blood, freely given or taken from a wound that is already there, shows them a true memory from the person it came from. The drop is a reading, and it does no harm. They keep the records a court will trust, and they wait to be asked through a door, which the towns take as manners. They can have children, though most of those children do not inherit the Condition, and violence, an accident, or a failed Tithe can still kill them.

Tithe. You carry three Memory tokens, and you check them at a long rest. Refill them if, since the last rest, you spent a Hope to recall a witnessed detail in full, read a memory from a drop of blood, or spent a downtime move in study or in witness. Hope is the push a player spends to make a moment land, and a downtime move is the quiet work a rest already gives you. If you did none of those things, remove a token. When no tokens remain, you are starving. A long rest that is still empty marks a Stress, the strain the sheet tracks apart from your Hit Points, and then a Hit Point. The last Hit Point taken this way is death, and there is no death move. The memories are gone, and you go still.

Two-Bodied. Old tales called them werewolves. The Tree Gives this Condition, and only the Tree, and about 18 percent of people carry a second animal self, anywhere from about a housecat's size up to a wolf, a bear, a boar, or a horse. That animal has its own name and its own mood, and you still choose when to change and every action the animal body takes. The Condition often runs in a family, and it often runs as the same animal.

Tithe. You spend part of each day as the animal. If a full day passes without that, the next roll with Fear shifts you, and you mark a Stress. A roll with Fear is one where the Fear die beat the Hope die, so the GM gains a Fear to spend on the scene. You still choose what the animal body does.

Returned. Old tales called them zombies. This Condition is Struck, and only by a death, and about 7 percent of people walk because of it. You died with a thing unfinished, and that Purpose is what keeps you walking. Plague wards, collapses, and the care of the dead are Returned work, because gore and deathly places do not shake you. When you would die, Avoid Death is closed, because you have already died once, and the moves still open are Blaze of Glory, Risk It All, and Refuse to Fall. Refuse to Fall crosses out a Hope slot, and you cannot Refuse to Fall if that would cross out the last Hope slot. When the Purpose is finished, you choose with the GM whether to lie down, to live on with no Condition, or to name a new Purpose and keep walking.

Tithe. If a long rest passes with nothing done toward the Purpose, mark a Stress you cannot clear until you act toward it, and your touch runs cold.

Bound. Old tales called them demons, and here the demon is the contract, not the birth. This Condition is Struck, and only by an oath you swore in extremity. About 5 percent of people are on this path, counting those who have already finished a term, and about 3.5 percent are Bound now. A counterparty granted you one small power your class does not already give you. You named Terms, which are the standing duties, and a Pledge, which is the piece of you paid when a limited term ends. An Infernis is born with demon blood, and that blood is a Kind. The oath is the Condition. The blood and the oath stay separate. A Bound person who signs contract after contract, until the other party effectively holds them, is called the Given-Over. A player character does not take that fate.

Tithe. Keep the Terms and the power works as written. Break a Term, or miss a payment, and the GM gains a Fear. Until you make restitution, the power costs a Hit Point instead of a Stress. While you are behind, a roll with Fear can bring a whisper, a thought or a lie. You may act against it. Shutting it out costs a Stress, and the whisper does not choose your action.

The Unbound. People also say the Hollow. This is what a finished term leaves, once the counterparty has taken the Pledge, and it is not a Condition you pick off a list. About 1.5 percent of people live this way, inside the 5 percent above. You go on without the piece you paid, and the missing piece is also a narrow immunity, agreed with the GM, against Stress or Fear that would have come through what was taken. You start here only if the table agrees that a Bound term has already ended.

Tithe. You carry three Quiet tokens. Spend one to act through the absence, or to roll with advantage where the absence makes the hard thing easier. Advantage is the better chance the game adds to a roll. At a long rest, refill them only if a person who knows your name shares the meal or the watch. When none remain, an offer of power looks unusually reasonable, and refusing it costs a Stress. You can still refuse.

Far-Voiced. Old tales called them sirens. This Condition can be Given or Struck, and about 12 percent of people carry a voice that travels as far as they mean it to, through distance, storm, fighting, or water, and that arrives with the feeling they intend. A Given Far-Voiced drew the sea-blue leaf and was trained. A Struck Far-Voiced survived a drowning and was not trained. It is the same Condition, and it is a different life. The voice does not choose what anyone else does.

Tithe. You carry three Breath tokens, and a long rest does not refill them. When you mark Stress from a feeling, or the GM names grief, terror, rage, or joy in the scene, you sing, cry, laugh, or weep before the scene ends. If you do not, remove a token. When none remain, the next strong feeling breaks out as a Cry. Everyone who hears it marks a Stress, you mark a Stress, and the tokens refill to two. The people who hear it still choose what they do.

The Stilled. Old tales called them gorgons. This Condition can be Given or Struck, and about 7 percent of people carry a Gaze that can pause a bleeding wound, a spreading poison, or a struggle they can see. The pause does not harm the person you hold. A Given Stilled trained from the pale-stone leaf. A Struck Stilled survived being turned to stone. Guilds licence the Gaze, because the same look that holds a wound can hold a fighter still.

Tithe. Grey tokens start at none. Add one each time you use the Gaze, and add one at a long rest that included no spar, drill, fight, or other hard physical work. A scene of that hard work clears one token at the end, if you marked Stress from the effort or you dealt or took damage. At three tokens, one of your own limbs locks stone-still, or a small thing nearby turns to stone, and the tokens then clear to one.

The Answered. Old tales called them djinn, a wish shut in a bottle for whoever held it, and there is no wish here and no master. The Tree Gives this Condition, and only the Tree, to about 10 percent of people. One element answered them and has kept answering: Ember for fire, Tide for water, Root for earth and stone, or Gale for air. You shape it with your hands. Once each long rest you may ask it one question it can feel through fire, water, stone, or air. It answers you, and it does not answer another person’s order. The element does not tell the town what sort of person you are, which is why people call an Answered a wildcard.

Tithe. You carry three tokens, and you check them at a long rest. Refill them if you spent Hope on the element’s Reach since the last rest. Reach is the stronger shaping you call on purpose, the one that costs a Hope, and the question you ask does not refill the tokens. If you did not spend that Hope, remove a token. When none remain, the element lets go in

your body, or in the air, water, and ground immediately around you. Other people take no direct harm from that, and the tokens refill to two.

The Taken-In. Old tales called them leshy. This Condition can be Given or Struck, and about 13 percent of people wear it where you can see it. Bark, moss, antler, or root shows on the body, and living plants lean toward you. Farms, herds, and wild roads depend on this work. A city crowd often keeps a little distance. A Given Taken-In grew up with the green, and a Struck Taken-In was lost and dying when the wild kept them alive.

Tithe. You carry three Green tokens, and you check them at a long rest. Refill them if you can touch a living plant where you rest. A tree, a field, or a window-box counts, and open sky with no plant does not. Otherwise remove a token. When none remain, mark a Stress, and you are Vulnerable until you touch living land, so any roll that targets you has a better chance of landing. The room around you grows over, the tokens refill to two, and that growth does not harm the people in the room.

Phoenix. People call them what the stories call them, because this is the one Condition the world already knows by its legend. The bird in those stories is reborn forever, and the rebirth costs the bird nothing. A Phoenix here is Given only, the Tree is the only way one begins, and each rise costs a piece of the old life. Fewer than one person in a thousand is a Phoenix, and only one Phoenix is alive in the whole world at a time, which is why a town that has never seen the white-fire leaf still knows who the stories are about. Fire and heat do you no harm, and you fly on wings of living fire, which you can keep hidden long enough to pass for a moment. The moment you fly, anyone watching knows what you are. Every other player agrees before anyone plays a Phoenix, and the GM may instead have the party meet the Phoenix as someone already in the world. If the Phoenix is not the public legend, the other players agree first, in the same way, and that player and the GM work out the rest.

Tithe. Each time you Rise From Ash, cross out a Hope slot. You return with your Hit Points cleared and your Stress still marked, and you are Vulnerable until your next rest. You cannot rise if that rise would cross out your last Hope slot, and that death is final. After it, a leaf falls somewhere for the next Phoenix. There is never a second living Phoenix while this one can still rise. A person who looks like a second Phoenix is not one.

Four ancestries

The stock Daggerheart ancestries live in the same towns as everyone else. If both of your ancestry features come from those stock ancestries, take a Hearth-Mark. Name the place that raised you, and write a place, not a Kind. Once each session, on a roll that leans on how that place taught you to live, add +2. That +2 costs no Hope. You may still spend Hope to add an Experience on the same roll. An Experience is one of the lived phrases on your sheet, the things you have already done and can lean on. A character who takes any feature from Kitsune, Selkie, Tengu, or Yumboe takes no Hearth-Mark.

Two ancestries can mix, by the rule in the System Reference Document, the published rules this game is built on. One parent gives the first feature on their list, and the other gives the second feature on theirs. A custom Kind’s third feature stays on the full Kind only. If either feature you took is from a custom Kind, you take no Hearth-Mark. Yumboe is taken whole, and a Yumboe character needs the GM’s leave.

Kitsune are the fox-born: slight, quick-eyed people with fox ears, one brush of tail, and foxfire, a cold pale light, at the fingertips. They are born with that shape already theirs, so the ears and the tail are a Kind, and the neighbours treat them as ordinary. A child takes after one parent, Wilds in the woods, Snows in the high cold, or Sands in the dry country. A Kitsune can slip aside from a blow, and can wear a glamour. The glamour changes what another person sees or hears, and it does not change the Kitsune’s body. The other person still decides what to do. Stories tell of nine tails, and that number is an honorific. The body has one tail.

Selkie are the sea-born, sleek and cool-skinned, and they carry a sealskin. It is a second self, put on or set down in a moment, and it is the Kind they were born to rather than a change that came later. In the water they are not harmed by the cold, they hold a long breath, and they know which way the surface is. A grip does not keep them. They always

know the direction back to the place where they left the skin. Loaning the skin, or having it taken, is a question of trust in the story, and the sheet has no penalty for it. Selkies are most numerous on coasts, and Kumbaan has none by birth.

Tengu are the crow-born of the high country: lean, sharp-featured people with dark feathers through their hair and down their arms, black bright eyes, and broad wings that carry them off any cliff or updraft. They are born with those wings, so the feathers are the Kind they arrived with, and their homes are ridges and cliff-shelves. They can fly, and they feel a storm, a rockfall, or bad ground in time to act, or in time to shout a warning. Only a Tengu is protected from being caught off guard, and the protection is the storm, the rockfall, and the bad ground. A person waiting in hiding can still catch a Tengu. Tengu in a lowland port are usually a courier's family, not a whole town of ridge-folk.

Yumboe call themselves the good people, Bakhna Rakhna in their own tongue. They are the people of Kumbaan, about waist-high to a mainlander, pearl-pale, with hair like spun silver, and they are awake at night. On the isle they are ordinary neighbours, at home under the hill. Off the isle, most towns have only the story. With the GM's leave, the character has the full set: at home under the hill, clear-sighted in the dark, and able to call hands and feet that have no body between them. Those hands fetch, pour, and serve. Damage is outside that work, and so is holding a creature that means to get free. The isle has no Turning Tree, so a Yumboe there is not Given a Condition. A Struck Condition can still happen, and on the isle it is rare.

The faiths

Five faiths are lived side by side. You belong to one by the rite you keep, not by a test of belief, and many houses keep more than one rite. The Leaf-Mother is a belief, and so are the other four, each of them an answer to what the Trees do, or to a land where no Tree stands.

The Motherfaith, whose own name is Maieth, is the common faith where Trees stand. It says a Condition is a gift that was chosen, and a hug is a gift of being left whole. Bringing the children, tending the Tithe, and keeping the festival are what make you part of it.

The Watching, whose own name is Haelthael, is Maiethorn's old Tree-faith. They stand at the same Leaf-Fall the Motherfaith keeps, and they will not call the Tree a mother, because they say the colour is a seeing.

The Fair Hand, Leddoren, belongs to Strandoren's ports and counting-houses. It says a Condition is a bargain, the Tithe is the term you pay, and a paid term leaves you even.

The Old Ways, Vaeloren, are the faith of Heskoren from before the grafts arrived. They say rivers, oath-stones, and groves were already making people, and a planted Tree is a guest.

The Open Table, whose own name is Ndeyaan, is the faith of Kumbaan, and there is no Tree on the isle. The rite is supper. The house sets an extra place, and a stranger who is fed on a second night is kin. A mainland watch does not take that kinship as papers.

The lands

Reach is how far the grafts have spread, the living pieces of the Awakening Tree carried out and planted. Close to that Tree, towns have many old Trees. Farther away, the Trees are fewer and younger, and more children miss a standing or are Struck alone. Beyond the last capes, one isle has no Tree at all.

Maiethorn, the Motherland, is the eastern continent, and you say it mah-YETH-orn. The Awakening Tree stands here, so the reach is full, and more children are Given here than in the world as a whole. A hug is less common here than elsewhere, though it is not rare, and every school on Maiethorn has Kept children. The powers here are Threnmaieth, Maiethvael, Orenbren, Saelthael, the Hinge Shore, and Lirorn, and the Watching and the Motherfaith argue at this centre.

Strandoren, the Shore-lands, lies west across the Old Crossing, the inner sea, and you say it stran-DOR-en. People often say Strandor. The reach is high, the long coasts live by trade, and the powers here are Lestrand, Brenledd, Leddvael, Trenledd, and Netstrand. The Fair Hand is at home in these ports.

Heskoren, the Sundered Reach, lies farther west and south, and you say it hesk-OR-en. People often say Heskorn. The reach is thin, and the planting is not finished. The powers here are Vaethorn, said Wetorn, Ornled, Vaelhesk, and Saelvaeth, and the Old Ways keep the old doors on this reach. Vaelhesk has no capital. The land itself is the seat.

Kumbaan, the Sundering Isle, lies past Heskoren's last capes, and you say it koom-BAHN. Sailors also say the Sunder. A storm-wall of weather, current, and reef wrecks most crossings, so no graft has ever crossed, and the isle has no Tree. The Yumboes live here, and the Open Table is theirs.

Those lists are the fifteen powers, one set to each of the three large continents. The isle is a home. It is not a sixteenth power. The three famous corners are Threnmaieth on Maiethorn, Lestrand on Strandoren, said LES-trand, and Vaethorn on Heskoren.

On the mainland, a day's walk runs from one mile-shrine to the next. A watch asks your name, the last hearth you belonged to, and who will stand for you, and two of those three answers are enough. Kumbaan does not use that custom.

Daily life

An ordinary household is mixed. A Selkie and a Returned person can be married, a Kept grandparent can share the house, and the children have not Turned yet, because a child does not Turn until the tenth year. A house like that has no special name.

Until the Leaf-Fall, a parent lives with one open question, which is what the child will become, or whether the leaves will hug them.

A Long-Lived person stops aging, and a spouse does not, and neither does a child. People say the cost of that Condition is counted in funerals. They mean the spouses and the children a Long-Lived person buries. Afterward, that person may live on alone, or marry again and outlive the next household too.

A town is laid out around its Tree, and it builds for Tithes the way it builds a well, a place where the upkeep can actually be met. Far-Voiced people have a hall where a feeling can be aired, Taken-In people have a public planting or pots of living plants, Long-Lived people have a library, and Two-Bodied people have open ground at the town's edge, where the animal body can work. Infirmaries of the Stilled, and workshops of the Answered, stand a little aside, because a bystander can be hurt there. The Returned tend the dead and walk into plague wards, so the living are not the ones sent in.

A household can be too poor to meet a Tithe. They can see what their kin needs, and they cannot always buy it or house it.

Feed a guest before anyone asks who the guest is. A funeral is a walk and then a meal, and it is not a Leaf-Fall. Neighbours carry the body along the street the person used, past the canopy, and the body is not stood under the branches for a colour.

Being a Condition is not a crime. Three licences exist, for the Stilled, the Far-Voiced, and the Answered, and a licence names a hazardous use, the Gaze, the Cry, or an element let loose. It does not name the Condition itself. A Bound contract is heard at a table, and that hearing is not a fourth licence.

Making a character

Do this once, in this order.

1. **Kind.** Take a stock ancestry, or Kitsune, Selkie, or Tengu, or a full Yumboe if the GM agrees. Or mix two ancestries as the published rules allow: the first feature from one parent, the second feature from the other. If both features are stock, add a Hearth-Mark, the place that raised you.
2. **Community.** Take a Community as the published rules define it, the card for the sort of people you were raised among. The Hearth-Mark does not fill this line.
3. **Class, Experiences, and equipment.** Take these as the published rules define them, and write two Experiences.

4. **Turning.** Write one of these four on the sheet.

- **Given.** A colour fell when you were ten. Take Long-Lived, Two-Bodied, the Answered, or Phoenix, or take Far-Voiced, the Stilled, or the Taken-In.
- **Kept.** The leaves hugged you, and the town saw it, so you have no Condition card and no Tithe. You owe no guild for a Condition, and you hold no Condition licence. At a long rest you take downtime while other people may be marking a Tithe, and that rest, with nothing to mark, is the tradeoff. Being Kept grants no extra Experience and no power of its own.
- **Struck.** The threshold is already in the backstory, and you name the person who stood for you afterward. Take Returned or Bound, or take Far-Voiced, the Stilled, or the Taken-In.
- **UnTurned.** You never stood under a Tree, so you have no card, and the sheet says UnTurned. Kept would mean the town watched a hug.

5. **The table agrees.** Every other player agrees before a Phoenix is played. If that Phoenix is not the public legend, the other players agree first, and the player and the GM work out the rest. The Unbound is not a starting card unless the table agrees the term already ended.

Kind and Condition remain two lines on the sheet. A Selkie can be Given Two-Bodied, a Human can be Struck Returned, and an Infernis who swears is Bound, while the blood they were born with stays a Kind.

During play, a Kept or UnTurned character can be Struck when the story crosses one of the thresholds above, and only if that player agrees to take the card. A failed roll is not a reason to hand someone a Condition. Long-Lived, Two-Bodied, the Answered, and Phoenix cannot be Struck. They are Given only, and there is no second Leaf-Fall.

Play a neighbour, a colleague, or a member of a family. The part of this world that is frightening is rare. It sits in a Tithe that is going unpaid, or in a tenth year that was missed. The Leaf-Fall is a warm week.